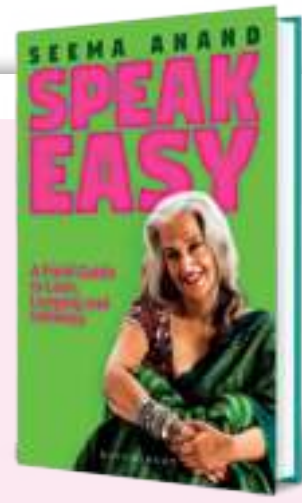
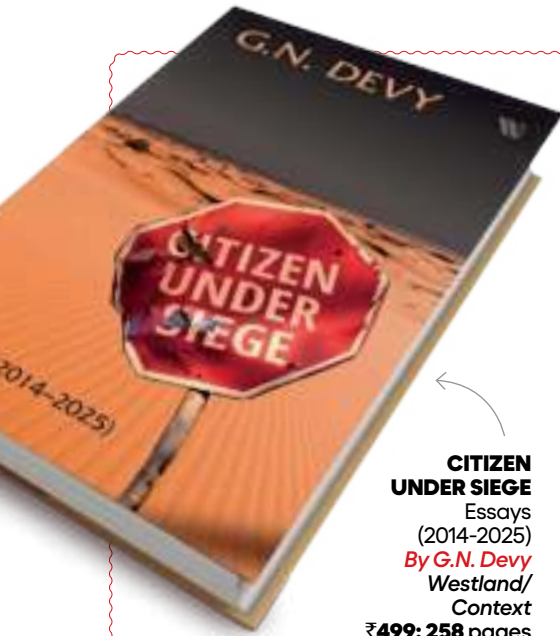
Where Curiosity Meets Compassion



SPEAK EASY
A Field Guide to Love, Longing and Intimacy
By Seema Anand
Bloomsbury
₹499; 278 pages

Storyteller and sex educator Seema Anand's *Speak Easy* is not your usual sex manual. It's less about technique and more a deep dive into questions that cannot be addressed in 60-second reels, questions which require nuanced responses full of context and balanced information. As Anand says in the 'Preface', "*Speak Easy* offers careful, thoughtful answers grounded in cultural and emotional contexts to questions that are both universal and as old as time."

Each chapter takes up a specific issue—everything from 'We were good in the first two years, but then I lost interest' to 'When it comes to sex, he just watches porn and masturbates as it is easier and less work', 'I knew he liked to cross-dress, and at first I was OK with it', 'Sex in the 50s for menopausal women', and, of course, 'Does size matter?'. Anand is that confidante, the one you wish you always had, in whose presence you never feel judged, and who has an answer for every silly-sounding question you may throw at her.



CITIZEN UNDER SIEGE
Essays (2014-2025)
By G.N. Devy
Westland/ Context
₹499; 258 pages

For the Love of Freedom

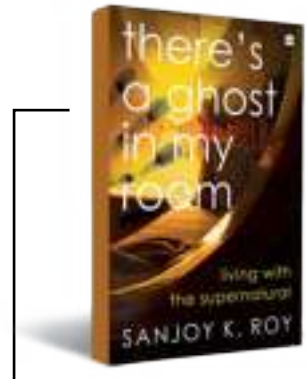
Currently Senior Professor of Eminence & Director, Somaiya School of Civilization Studies, G.N. Devy is a distinguished academic and cultural activist who, among his many considerable achievements, has also conceptualised and spearheaded the 50-volume *People's Linguistic Survey of India*. This slim volume brings together over 40 short essays written over the last 10 years, Devy's response to what he sees as growing authoritarianism and state overreach.

GROWTH PANGS

Malala Yousafzai was catapulted into the international limelight after being shot at point-blank range by the Taliban at the age of 15, setting her life on a rather unexpected trajectory. *Finding My Way* is a deeply personal coming-of-age memoir in which Malala tries to unburden herself from the various identities thrown at her—Nobel Laureate, global icon and activist, successful academic, and so on—in writing that is supple and self-assured.



FINDING MY WAY
By Malala Yousafzai
Hachette/ Weidenfeld & Nicolson
₹699; 320 pages



THERE'S A GHOST IN MY ROOM Living With the Supernatural
By Sanjoy K. Roy
HarperCollins India
₹599; 224 pages

A Strange & Sublime Memoir

Who knew the man behind over 30 acclaimed festivals has had a parallel existence—enjoying friendly relations with the spirit world all his life, from childhood encounters in his ancestral home in Calcutta to ones in the sprawling Lutyens' bungalow where he grew up, and throughout his travels across India and the world. Read it to believe it.

—Compiled by Amit Dixit